Thays Santos Ek

Product Designer | UX/UI | Digital Products

📍 Stockholm, Sweden | ✉️thays.santos.ek@gmail.com | 🔗 LinkedIn | 💻 Portfolio | 📱 +46 76 0819938

Profile

Product Designer with 5+ years of experience designing and researching digital products, backed by 10+ years of software engineering experience. Experienced in owning the design process from identifying user problems and conducting research to prototyping, testing, and delivering production-ready experiences.

I enjoy working in fast-moving, cross-functional environments where designers have ownership and influence what gets built. Strong background in user research, rapid prototyping, design systems, accessibility, and collaborating closely with engineers. Passionate about using technology to create engaging, intuitive experiences that help people learn, create, and solve problems.

Core Skills

End-to-End Product Design • Mobile Product Design (iOS & Android) • UX/UI Design • Design Systems • Accessibility • Interaction Design • Prototyping • User Research • Workshop Facilitation • Product Strategy • Cross-Functional Collaboration • AI-assisted research synthesis • AI prototyping (Lovable, Figma Make) • Claude • GitHub Copilot

Professional Experience

Viaplay Group –Product Designer

May 2024 – Present | Stockholm

- Own product design work across discovery, research, prototyping, testing, and delivery for streaming experiences.
- Built a Figma plugin for accessibility checks using Claude and turned the accessibility guidelines into Copilot-searchable Markdown documentation.
- Enhanced the player experience across 6 platforms: iOS, Android, tvOS, Android TV, big screens, and Chromecast.
- Conducted user interviews and usability testing to identify needs, validate concepts, and inform product decisions.
- Used A/B testing and user insights to drive data-informed product improvements.
- Updated and extended the design system with workflows for player screens and personalized content blocks.
- Advocated for accessibility standards and mentored peers in inclusive design.

Hot Buttered Eyewear Brazil – Freelance UX Designer

Feb 2024 – May 2024 | Remote

- Designed mobile B2B platform for eyewear stores, focusing on users 40+ years old.
- Delivered UI kit in Figma, prototypes, and usability tests with recruited users.
- Improved ordering flow, reducing backend request overload and increasing speed.

Viaplay Group – UX Researcher & Product Designer

Sep 2022 – Oct 2023 | Stockholm

- Evangelized user-centric vision by running cross-team workshops (Engineering & Streaming).
- Delivered research repository to centralize insights and accelerate decision-making.
- Conducted end-to-end research: study plans, recruitment, interviews, data analysis (quant & qual), reporting.
- Collaborated with Devs, QA, and PMs to improve live streaming satisfaction.

Accedo.tv – Android Developer

2018–2020 & 2023–2024 | Stockholm

- Built Android mobile & TV apps for leading streaming platforms.
- Collaborated closely with design teams to ensure best-in-class UI/UX.

Earlier Technology Experience

- Android Developer – Neemu/Linx (2015–2017)
- Development Engineer – SIDIA (Samsung R&D Institute) (2012–2015)
- Java Web Developer – FUCAPI (2011–2012)

Key Projects & Achievements

- Player Redesign (Viaplay, 2024–25): Unified fragmented player across platforms. Conducted 10+ interviews, ran workshops, and delivered redesign that boosted clarity in live vs replay use cases.
- Post-Watch Improvements (Viaplay, 2025): Increased engagement by 8% through redesigned post-watch flows and accessibility updates.
- Hot Buttered Eyewear (2024): Enabled faster purchases and improved usability for B2B clients (40+ demographic). Delivered full design system foundations.
- Master Thesis (KTH, 2022): Co-designing with neurodiverse users (ADHD & dyslexia) in streaming platforms.

Education

- KTH Royal Institute of Technology – M.Sc. Computer Science & Engineering, Interactive Media Technology (2020–2022)
- Aela.io – Professional Certification, Product Design (2019–2021)
- Universidade Federal do Amazonas – B.Sc. Computer Engineering (2006–2010)

Community Leadership

Chapter Leader, Ladies that UX Stockholm: Organizing events that empower women and non-binary individuals in design.